LORA ANDERSON

OPERATIONS LEADERSHIP AND BUSINESS IMPROVEMENT

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Cross-functional operations leader with experience across commercial businesses and nonprofit organizations, focused on identifying opportunities for growth and continuous improvement. Experienced in leading teams, managing diverse business functions, and developing solutions that improve efficiency, strengthen processes, and support organizational performance. Consistently combines curiosity with practical business judgment to solve complex operational challenges.

LEADERSHIP AND AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Organizational Leadership: Led company-wide operations and department managers, participated in strategic and succession planning, and made operational and resource decisions.

People Operations and Human Resources: Managed full-cycle HR, workforce development, employee relations, payroll, training, performance management, and compliance.

Operational Excellence: Diagnosed inefficient workflows and built policies, standard operating procedures (SOPs), controls, and automated processes that improve consistency and free up capacity.

Financial Authority and Governance: Managed budgets, banking access, purchasing, corporate credit card controls, vendor agreements, and organizational spending.

Business Intelligence and Analytics: Leveraged analytical tools such as SQL, Power Query, Power BI, and Excel to develop KPI frameworks and dashboards, interpret performance trends, identify risks and opportunities, and make informed operational and strategic decisions.

Technology and Systems: Led software selection and implementation, system administration, hardware lifecycle planning and management, workflow automation, and technology initiatives across departments.

Project and Change Management: Led projects and organizational change initiatives supporting business growth, competitive contract awards, grant funding, and adoption of new systems and processes.

Selected Results at a Glance

- **Cost reduction:** Reduced recurring operating expenses by more than **$100,000 annually** through vendor renegotiations.
- **Business growth:** Helped grow a technology startup into a regional provider with hundreds of customer contracts and an eventual profitable sale.
- **Employee retention:** Partnered on an onboarding redesign linked to an approximately **65% reduction in regrettable attrition** at one residential program.
- **Decision support:** Established **100+ organizational KPIs** and Power BI reporting for executive and board use.
- **Contract awards:** Prepared **three successful OregonBuys proposals**: two SOESD school-based counseling contracts and one TFCO contract.
- **Grant funding:** Identified funding opportunities and wrote proposals that secured approximately **$60,000 in awarded grants**.
- **Policy automation:** Built a **review and approval workflow** supporting oversight of approximately 300 organizational policies.
- **System Implementation:** Led and supported **major technology implementations**, including multiple HRIS platforms, QuickBooks Desktop and Online, and Microsoft 365, improving business processes and supporting organizational adoption.

Selected Professional Work: Professional Solutions - Real-World Projects and Case Studies

Professional Experience

FAMILY SOLUTIONS - OPERATIONS MANAGER

Ashland, Oregon | Aug 2022 - Sep 2026

Served as an active member of senior leadership, helping shape organizational strategy, planning, and major initiatives. Oversaw multiple operational departments **with direct decision making authority**, including banking and corporate credit card management.

- **Cost reduction:** Renegotiated three major vendor relationships, cutting recurring annual expenses by more than **$100,000**.
- **Performance reporting:** Built the first organization-wide KPI framework, defining more than 100 measures and creating Power BI reports for executive and board decisions.
- **Competitive bids:** Wrote three successful OregonBuys submissions, securing two SOESD school-based counseling contracts and one TFCO contract.
- **Grant-funded improvements:** Identified funding and wrote proposals securing approximately **$60,000**; supervised facility improvement projects and monitored awarded funds and budgets.
- **Policy governance:** Designed automated review and approval tracking for approximately 300 policies, improving visibility into ownership, deadlines, and decisions.

FRIENDS OF CHILDREN AND FAMILIES - HUMAN RESOURCES SPECIALIST

Orlando, Florida | Aug 2021 - Aug 2022

Managed all human resources functions for a multisite nonprofit mental health organization. Also coordinated the organization's safety, maintenance, and IT functions.

- **Employee retention:** Co-designed structured onboarding, phased training, mentoring, and early check ins; regrettable attrition at one residential program declined by roughly 65%.
- **Workforce reporting:** Developed workforce, turnover, and compliance reporting used in recurring board discussions.
- **HR systems:** Supported Paychex implementation and training while managing Relias learning and compliance workflows.

NATIONAL BUILDERS & ACCEPTANCE CORPORATION - BUSINESS OFFICE MANAGER

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania | Jan 2017 - Apr 2021

Served as senior operations leader reporting directly to the CEO. Directed all departments, with authority over operational and financial decisions, strategic planning, and resource allocation for a property portfolio of more than 100 units.

- **Business controls:** Rebuilt records, financial controls, and operating procedures after an ownership transition, giving the organization a more reliable management foundation.
- **Technology modernization:** Replaced the company's ledger accounting system with QuickBooks Desktop, building the new accounting structure from the ground up. Selected and implemented Buildium to centralize property and tenant management.
- **Performance visibility:** Built a dashboard tracking approximately 50 operating and workforce KPIs to support management decisions.
- **Project delivery:** Managed renovation projects and vendor work with budgets, schedules, and cost tracking; built reporting to compare project spending with budget.
- **Marketing and Digital Communications:** Improved the company's digital presence through stronger rental listings, property photography, and targeted social media campaigns to attract prospective tenants.
- **Business Continuity and Crisis Management:** Adapted operations and financial planning during the COVID-19 pandemic, supported PPP funding efforts, and developed a rental strategy targeting traveling healthcare workers to expand the market for vacant properties.

Professional Experience (continued)

WorkWell - Workers Compensation Medical Care Case Manager
Carnegie, Pennsylvania | Sep 2013 - Dec 2016

Managed more than **100 complex claims** and served as dedicated case management contact for the firm's largest client, coordinating employers, medical providers, insurers, and injured workers.

- **Client and risk analysis:** Participated in monthly client reviews with leadership and evaluated injury patterns to identify prevention opportunities.

PC Geeks - Operations Manager
Enid, Oklahoma | Oct 2006 - Aug 2013

Reported directly to the CEO and directed companywide operations, with authority over operational and financial decisions and an active role in strategic planning as the business expanded.

- **Regional business growth:** Helped grow from a handful of custom software projects to hundreds of contracts serving schools and businesses across northwestern Oklahoma.
- **Organizational scale:** Built operating processes and management structure as the business expanded to approximately 42 employees and multiple service lines.
- **Workforce stability:** Developed supervisors and HR processes while maintaining **annual employee turnover below 10%.**
- **Business Systems Improvement:** Partnered with technical teams to improve custom databases and applications, translating operational needs into practical system improvements and more efficient workflows.
- **Long-term business value:** Helped build the operating foundation of a diversified technology company that was ultimately sold for a substantial profit.

Earlier Experience

CASA - Case Manager | May 2001 - Oct 2006

Managed more than 60 child-advocacy cases, supervised 15–25 volunteers, and prepared recommendations for court proceedings.

Main Street Enid - Program Assistant | Jun 1998 - May 2001

Managed conference center and event operations, created the organization's website, and presented information to the board and city council.

Technology and Programs

Power BI | Advanced Microsoft Excel | Power Query | SQL | VBA/Macros | Power Automate | Tableau | Maria DB | Microsoft Office | Microsoft 365 Administration | SharePoint | Intune | PowerShell | UKG Ready | ADP Workforce Now | Paychex | Relias LMS | QuickBooks Desktop | QuickBooks Online | CareLogic | Oracle | PeopleSoft | Google Workspace | DocuSign | UniFi/Ubiquiti | Genuity | Slack | Microsoft Forms | Microsoft Copilot | ChatGPT | Claude | Adobe Acrobat | WordPress | Shopify

Education

Master of Arts, Behavioral Science - Northwestern Oklahoma State University
Bachelor of Arts, Psychology and Business - Oklahoma State University